

Rahul Patni

U.S. Citizen

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SUMMARY

Technical founder with multiple exits who ships fast and acquires customers. Has built companies from zero, hired and scaled engineering teams, and navigated acquisitions. Understands what to build at each stage from startup to public company.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Coinbase

March 2025 - present

Technical Lead, Base Privacy

Seattle, WA

- Architected payments infrastructure for private onchain rails built on trusted execution environments: ledger accounting, bookkeeping systems, customer-facing APIs, and user interfaces (Rust/Go)
- Designed and shipped Base Verify, an identity verification infrastructure that scaled to 250K verifications in its first month. Defined observability targets and monitoring to drive scaling decisions
- Drove developer adoption from zero: designed public APIs, built the integration ecosystem, authored end-to-end documentation, and onboarded 10+ partners resulting in 5 production launches
- Led cross-functional integrations with external platforms (TikTok, X, Instagram) including navigating legal approvals and debugging third-party OAuth issues
- Built AI-powered code quality infrastructure: multi-model agent PR review pipeline, automated deduplication and type safety enforcement across Rust services

Ironfish – acquired by Coinbase

August 2023 - March 2025

Staff Software Engineer

Seattle, WA

- Led bridge integration that unlocked cross-chain liquidity for Ironfish's private UTXO chain, directly contributing to the acquisition by Coinbase
- Reduced time to connect with max peers by 90% through peer networking performance improvements
- Shipped the industry's first privacy-preserving multi-signature wallets by implementing FROST threshold signatures into the core protocol

Fire (incubated at Atomic, acquired by Kerberos)

November 2021 – August 2023

Co-Founder/ Lead Engineer

Seattle, WA

- Scaled Fire from 0 to 500K+ monthly active users. Hired, mentored, and managed a team of 3 engineers through to acquisition. Used A/B testing and analytics to drive feature development
- Built a transaction simulation engine that forked the Ethereum blockchain in real-time to preview execution outcomes. Detected malicious or unexpected behavior before users signed, kept current with the latest ERCs and EIPs to cover emerging attack vectors
- Incubated at Atomic as Engineer in Residence. Served as technical cofounder across 5 company formations before joining Fire full-time

Ridgeline

Oct. 2018 – Nov. 2021

Technical Lead (Accounting)

Incline Village, NV

- Joined as the 15th employee and managed 9 engineers across three product teams (fixed income, reconciliation, and core accounting), scaled to 80B AUM
- Designed customer-facing APIs and architected the platform's double-entry accounting system from scratch: automated reconciliation, a configurable rules engine for multi-asset journaling, and fixed income transaction processing
- Created a testing framework for microservices that enabled PMs and CPAs to validate code without engineering, reducing release cycles by 70%
- Conducted 200+ engineering interviews, mentored engineers, and helped define engineering leveling as the company grew from 15 to 250+ employees

EDUCATION

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

Aug. 2014 - May 2018

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

GPA: 3.97/4.00

SKILLS

Rust, TypeScript, React, Python, Go, GraphQL, AWS, PostgreSQL, NoSQL, Docker, Kubernetes, Distributed Systems
Blockchain Infrastructure, Ethereum, Smart Contracts, ZKPs, TEEs, AI/LLM Agents